

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Quick Vs. Speedy!

Q I have a Pentium III 700 MHz machine with Windows 98 SE. For the last few months, I've been putting up with two viruses (or possibly its variants)—“Putta.com” and “Speedy.bat”. I use Quick Heal version 7.0 with recently-updated definition files, but it's unable to remove all traces of these viruses.

Pavan Jain

A Your computer seems to be affected by W32.Opaserv.ad.Worm, which exploits a security vulnerability in 9x/Me systems, allowing it to access shares without the password. If Quick Heal is unable to remove the virus, you could try using another anti-virus, or cleaning the virus manually.

To do a manual clean, first boot your machine in Safe Mode and manually delete any files that Quick Heal detects. If you're unable to delete files because they are in use, use a free-ware such as Unlocker (<http://ccollomb.free.fr/unlocker/>) to get rid of them. Next, in the Registry Editor, navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\Run, and remove any entries that point to “speedy.bat”, “putta.com”, and any files that Quick Heal identifies as a virus or as any other kind of suspicious file. Repeat this under HKEY_CURRENT_USER.

Next, go to Start > Run, type in “sysedit”, and go to the win.ini window. Look for a line similar to “run = speedy.bat”, and remove everything after “run=”. Reboot your system after these changes, and then apply the patch available at www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/MS00-072.msp to fix the vulnerabilities exploited by the virus.

Damn Drivers!

Q I use a Dell Optiplex GX280 Desktop. I wanted to use a modem, and I ordered a PCI raiser card (A card with additional PCI slots). I installed my modem on Windows XP SP1, but after installing the default driver, I got an error message saying, “Your hardware won't work properly until reboot.” When I restarted my computer, I got a blue screen error saying “IRQ_LESS_OR_NOT_EQUAL.” What does that mean? In Windows XP, IRQ conflicts are not a problem, like they once were in Win9x, as one of my other systems with the same configuration doesn't have this problem.

Uday Sharma

A Your problem seems to be directly related to the default drivers for your modem. Since you haven't mentioned the manufacturer and model, you might want to check if Windows has included your product in the Hardware Compatibility List. If it isn't supported, you can install the drivers for your modem from the manufacturer's Web site, or visit www.driverguide.com for updated drivers for your card.

Silent Movies

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.5 GHz running Windows XP. I recently bought a Samsung 16x DVD-Writer. It functions well while burning, but when I play movies, there is no audio. I have no problems with the video though.

G Abhilash

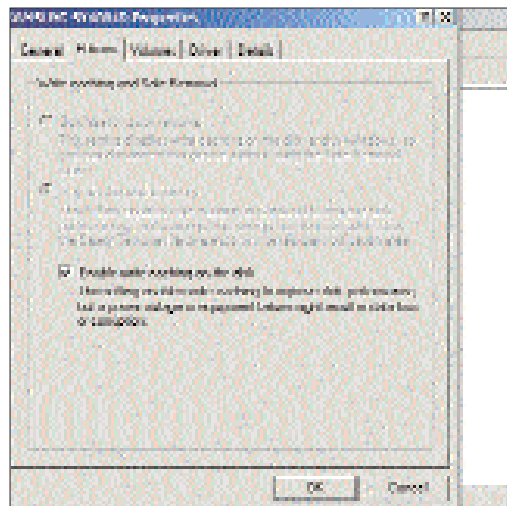
A To make sure the audio settings are correct, look for settings such as digital output, SPDIF, and 3D audio support in your player and sound card driver software. Disable them one by one. If the problem persists, you will need to install the proper audio codecs. You can also try free players with inbuilt codecs—such as VLC Media Player—which is distributed on our CD every month.

Putting It Off

Q I have a Pentium 4 2.60 GHz processor on an ASUS P4XP-X motherboard. Recently, while performing some tests, I got a message: “Warning: Disk write caching is disabled.” What is disk write caching, and how can I enable it? My hard disk is a Seagate ST340014A.

Arun Kafley

A In disk write caching, instead of writing data immediately to disk, a “note” is made to finish the task later, which could be when your PC shuts down, or during an idle period. Enabling it could improve disk performance, but there's a possibility of lost or corrupted data if Windows does not shut down properly.



Disk write caching can improve performance at the cost of possible corrupted data in the event of a crash